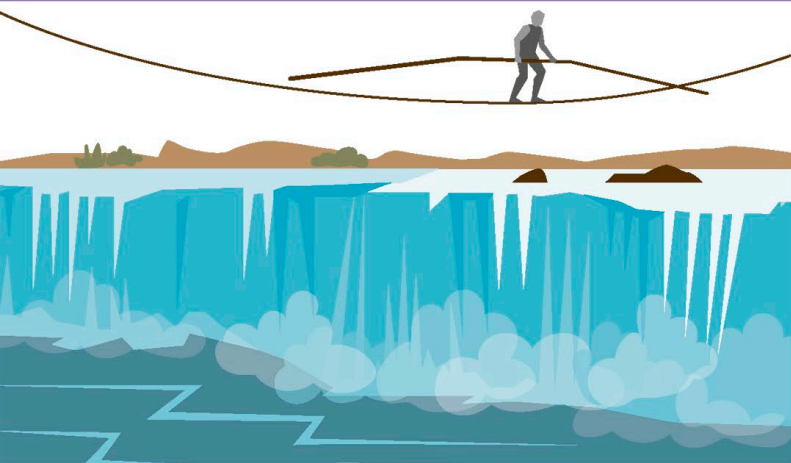


June

30



A balancing act

French daredevil Charles Blondin became the first person to cross Niagara Falls, on the US/Canada border, on a tightrope. He used no safety nets or harnesses.

1859

First Black astronaut

1967

After passing his flight training, Black American pilot Robert Henry Lawrence, Jr was selected to join the US Air Force's Manned Orbiting Laboratory, a secret espionage programme. This made him the first Black astronaut.



Born this day

1985 Michael Phelps, US swimmer. Nicknamed the Flying Fish, he is the most successful Olympic athlete of all time, with a record 23 gold medals.

Also on this day

1908 A massive explosion over a remote area of Siberia, Russia, flattened an estimated 80 million trees. It was probably caused by an asteroid breaking up above Earth's surface.

1960 The present-day Democratic Republic of the Congo gained independence from Belgium.

2016 The United Nations agreed to take action to protect people from discrimination and violence based on their sexual or gender identities.

London landmark

1894

Tower Bridge, in London, UK, was officially declared open after eight years of construction. The bridge remains one of the city's most famous landmarks.

